

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 366

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor the life and ministry of Brother Ronnie Smith.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of the General Assembly should honor those individuals who have answered a divine call to the ministry and who have served with dedication, vigor, and enthusiasm to perform God's work for their congregations and their communities; and

WHEREAS, one such dedicated church leader is Brother Ronnie Smith, who has served his community and congregation well for the past several decades; and

WHEREAS, born on March 7, 1946, to Homer O. and Attie Chillon Nixon Smith, Brother Smith first felt the call to ministry as a junior in high school when he was attending Beechmont Baptist Church in Kentucky, and after being licensed by Beechmont Baptist Church and ordained by First Baptist Church in Watertown, he began his first pastorate at Whorton Springs Baptist Church in 1968; and

WHEREAS, once he completed his pastorates at Whorton Springs Baptist Church, Hurricane Baptist Church, and Bellwood Baptist Church, Brother Smith shifted away from full-time ministry from 1978 to 1987, but always ready to utilize his God-given gifts to guard the fold, he faithfully served the people of God at Upper Helton Baptist Church, Cedar Grove Baptist Church, and Linwood Baptist Church as interim pastor in their times of need; and

WHEREAS, Brother Smith returned to full-time ministry to serve Hurricane Baptist Church and New Hope Baptist Church, congregations that he moved between from 1987 onward, and as the currently acting pastor of Hurricane Baptist Church, he continues to pour himself out for the sake of his flock, edifying those under his care with his ever-present concern and Christ-like compassion; and

WHEREAS, apart from his ministerial journey, Brother Smith was also a history and Spanish teacher for forty-five years, educating at Woodbury High School, Mount Juliet Middle School, Watertown High School, and Cumberland College; and

WHEREAS, an erudite educator, Brother Smith graduated from Middle Tennessee State University with a Bachelor of Science degree and master's degree, and he later received a doctorate degree through extension courses at Lake Charles Bible College; and

WHEREAS, helping ill students achieve the same academic rigor as the classroom, Brother Smith worked in Wilson County as a homebound teacher from 1973 to 1985, and his scholastic mastery and endless empathy enabled his pupils to consistently succeed; and

WHEREAS, Brother Smith's commitment to God, his spiritual leadership, and his love for people, as demonstrated over his past years of service, are worthy of our respect and admiration; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Brother Ronnie Smith, commending him for his honorable service and spiritual inspiration and wishing him every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.